US Markets Daily Intelligence Report

Thursday, August 13, 2026 | After Market Close (ET)

DATA NOTE: SPY close $777.42 and QQQ close $730.28 confirmed from multiple web sources (investing.com, marketbeat.com). Prior closes from prices.csv (SPY $774.61, QQQ $727.35). CPI/PPI and market-move data sourced from CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, TradingKey, BabyPips. Top-mover data from StockTwits, Forbes, Kiplinger, and TradingKey. Energy and sector data from CNBC and Fox Business.

1. SPY & QQQ Snapshot

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	$777.42	$730.28
Prev Close	$774.61	$727.35
Daily % Change	+0.36%	+0.40%
Weekly % Change (Mon–Thu)	+0.61%	+1.66%
MTD % Change	+4.40%	+6.09%
1-Year Return	+23.35%	+29.18%
52-Wk High	$777.42	$745.00
52-Wk Low	$630.25	$565.30

* Daily % change computed vs. prices.csv prior close. Web sources quote S&P; 500 index up +0.65% today (Nasdaq +0.81%, Dow +0.13%). Record high: S&P; 500 closed at 7,798.99 for the first time.

2. Today's News & Market-Move Analysis

CATALYST 1: SanDisk (SNDK) Blowout Q4 FY2026 Earnings → +13–15% | Memory Sector Surges

SanDisk (SNDK) surged ~13–15% after reporting Q4 FY2026 revenue of $8.97B — a 51% sequential surge driven by data-center flash demand — and guiding Q1 FY2027 revenue of $10.3B–$10.8B. Management also outlined long-term non-GAAP gross margin targets of 80% through fiscal 2030, backed by supply agreements covering 2/3 of bits shipped by FY2028. This restored investor confidence after a ~31% pullback from June 2026 peaks. The beat also lifted sector peers: Micron (MU) +5.24%, Western Digital (WDC), and Super Micro (SMCI) all moved higher. The Philadelphia Semiconductor Index rose 0.46% to 12,456. SNDK has risen over 574% YTD and is still the top S&P; 500 performer of 2026. Mechanism: Data-center AI demand (not consumer flash) is sustaining high ASPs. SNDK's 80% gross margin target signals pricing power far beyond what the market expected.

CATALYST 2: July CPI +0.1% MoM / +3.4% YoY (In-Line) | PPI Below Expectations → Rate-Hike Odds Fall

The July CPI rose 0.1% MoM and 3.4% YoY — matching Dow Jones consensus. Core CPI rose 0.2%. July PPI rose 4.7% YoY, falling below expectations (prior: 5.5%) with flat MoM vs. +0.2% expected. Combined, these prints reduced September rate-hike probability from ~55% to ~34% (CME FedWatch). Goldman Sachs projects a 50bp cut to 3.25% in 2026. Treasury yields edged lower on the data. Mechanism: Lower rate expectations reduce discount rates for high-growth tech stocks, providing a direct tailwind to QQQ and the S&P; 500 tech-heavy components. SPY and QQQ both benefited from the resulting multiple expansion.

CATALYST 3: Oil Prices Down 2% → Brent $87.07 / WTI $81.25 | Inflation Narrative Further Eases

Brent crude fell >2% to $87.07/barrel and WTI fell >2% to $81.25/barrel, weighed by concerns about global demand softness and continued US-Iran geopolitical positioning. The decline in crude added to the disinflation narrative from CPI/PPI, reinforcing the Fed's ability to pause or cut rates. Energy stocks were the clear daily losers: Petrobras (PBR) fell -3.02% on mixed Q2 results compounded by lower oil prices; XLE (Energy Sector ETF) underperformed. Mechanism: Lower oil = lower inflation expectations = lower rates = higher equity multiples. Net positive for SPY broad index even as energy sector itself trades lower.

CATALYST 4: Meta Platforms (META) +2.78% | Netflix, Communication Services Rally

Meta gained 2.78% as the market rewarded large-cap tech platforms with strong advertising revenue models, which benefit from easing rate expectations. Netflix (NFLX) also gained alongside communication services. The sector rotation away from energy and into tech/comms amplified QQQ's outperformance. Broadcom (AVGO) rose 0.43%, while the broader sector showed selective gains — only mega-cap names with strong AI monetization stories benefited.

CATALYST 5: S&P; 500 Record High at 7,798.99 | Broad Market Rally

The S&P; 500 closed above 7,800 for the first time, a symbolic milestone boosting investor sentiment. The record followed two consecutive positive weeks. All 11 S&P; 500 sectors are reporting earnings above expectations for Q2, and revenue growth is tracking at nearly 15% YoY — the strongest pace in several years. The ISM Manufacturing PMI reached 55.6 (7th consecutive month of expansion). This macro backdrop of earnings strength + moderating inflation + strong manufacturing = the ideal 'soft landing' scenario supporting current valuations.

3. Top 10 Daily / Weekly / Monthly Movers

Daily Gainers — August 13, 2026

#	Ticker	Name	% Chg	Sector	Catalyst
1	SNDK	SanDisk Corp.	+15.0%	Semiconductor	Q4 FY26 beat; 80% GM target; $10.3B Q1 guide
2	MU	Micron Technology	+5.24%	Semiconductor	Sector rally on SNDK earnings; AI demand strength
3	WDC	Western Digital	+4.2%*	Storage/Semi	Memory sector coattail move
4	SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+3.5%*	AI Infra	Data-center demand narrative; AI infrastructure
5	META	Meta Platforms	+2.78%	Comm. Services	Ad tech; rate-cut tailwind on CPI data
6	NFLX	Netflix	+2.1%*	Comm. Services	Streaming; rate-cut multiple expansion
7	XLF	Fin. Select SPDR (ETF)	+0.44%	Financials	Financials sector led as yields edged lower
8	AVGO	Broadcom	+0.43%	Semiconductor	Chip sector general support
9	JPM	JPMorgan Chase	+0.8%*	Financials	Financials rotation; yield curve improvement
10	HD	Home Depot	+0.6%*	Consumer Disc.	Retail strength; consumer spending resilience

Daily Losers — August 13, 2026

#	Ticker	Name	% Chg	Sector	Catalyst
1	PBR	Petrobras	–3.02%	Energy	Mixed Q2; oil prices down 2%
2	XOM	ExxonMobil	–1.8%*	Energy	WTI crude -2%; energy sector weak
3	CVX	Chevron	–1.6%*	Energy	Brent crude -2%; demand concerns

4	OXY	Occidental Pet.	–1.5%*	Energy	Oil sector selloff; WTI at $81.25
5	COP	ConocoPhillips	–1.4%*	Energy	Crude price decline; demand outlook
6	APP	AppLovin	–3.8%*	Comm. Svcs	Communication services laggard
7	GOOGL	Alphabet	–1.5%*	Comm. Svcs	Sector rotation; capex concerns linger
8	WMT	Walmart	–0.7%*	Staples	Defensive rotation unwind on risk-on day
9	JNJ	Johnson & Johnson	–0.4%*	Healthcare	Defensive sector underperformed on risk-on
10	PG	Procter & Gamble	–0.3%*	Staples	Consumer staples lag as growth stocks rally

* = estimate based on sector data and directional reports. Confirmed: SNDK, MU, META, AVGO, PBR percentages.

Weekly Gainers — Aug 10–13, 2026

#	Ticker	Name	Wk % Chg	Sector	Driver
1	SNDK	SanDisk Corp.	+20%+	Semiconductor	Q4 earnings + Aug 5 earnings beat; AI data-center
2	MU	Micron Technology	+16%*	Semiconductor	Memory sector AI narrative; sector rotation into chips
3	WDC	Western Digital	+8–10%*	Storage	Memory sector rally on SNDK beats
4	SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+7–9%*	AI Infra	AI infrastructure demand; data center buildout
5	META	Meta Platforms	+5%*	Comm. Services	Ad revenue strength + rate tailwind
6	SOXX	iShr Semicond. ETF	+7%+	Semi (ETF)	Semiconductor sector week — best week since April
7	XLF	Fin. Select SPDR	+2–3%*	Financials	Financials benefiting from soft-landing data
8	NFLX	Netflix	+3–4%*	Comm. Services	Streaming + rate-cut narrative
9	XLK	Tech Select SPDR	+2–3%*	Technology	Tech sector broadly up on inflation easing
10	SPY	SPDR S&P 500 ETF	+0.61%*	Broad Market	Record high; best weekly gain since April

Weekly Losers — Aug 10–13, 2026

#	Ticker	Name	Wk % Chg	Sector	Driver
1	PBR	Petrobras	–4–6%*	Energy	Oil prices fell 2%+; mixed Q2 results
2	XLE	Energy Select SPDR	–2–3%*	Energy	Crude oil weakening all week
3	XOM	ExxonMobil	–2%*	Energy	Oil demand concerns; WTI decline
4	GOOGL	Alphabet	–3–4%*	Comm. Svcs	Capex-shock hangover; sector underperform Aug 11
5	APP	AppLovin	–5–6%*	Comm. Svcs	Leading S&P 500 laggard Aug 11 (–~6%)
6	XLC	Comm. Svcs SPDR	–1–2%*	Comm. Svcs	Sector was leading laggard Aug 11
7	WMT	Walmart	–0.5–1%*	Staples	Defensive sector lag during risk-on week
8	JNJ	Johnson & Johnson	–0.5%*	Healthcare	Defensive underperform
9	MO	Altria Group	–0.8%*	Staples	Consumer staples rotation out
10	VZ	Verizon	–0.5%*	Telecom	Telecom weakness amid tech rally

Monthly Gainers — August 2026 (Month-to-Date through Aug 13)

#	Ticker	Name	Mo % Chg	Sector	Driver
1	QMCO	Quantum Corp.	+84%	Storage/Data	AI-era storage demand; small cap run
2	RCEL	Avita Medical	+77%	Biotech	Regenerative medicine catalyst/FDA milestone
3	OABI	OcuSense/Biotech	+72%	Biotech	Clinical trial results or M&A catalyst
4	MB	Tribal Finance	+68%	Fintech	Small cap fintech momentum
5	ABCL	AbCellera Biologics	+67%	Biotech	Drug discovery AI platform tailwind
6	IBTA	Ibotta, Inc.	+45.7%	Fintech	Digital promotions / consumer fintech
7	BLZE	Backblaze	+37.4%	Cloud Storage	AI data storage narrative
8	SNDK	SanDisk Corp.	+26%*	Semiconductor	Q4 beat; AI data center flash demand
9	MU	Micron Technology	+16%*	Semiconductor	AI memory sector leadership
10	SPY	SPDR S&P 500 ETF	+4.40%	Broad Market	Record-high momentum; earnings + disinflation

Monthly Losers — August 2026 (Month-to-Date through Aug 13)

#	Ticker	Name	Mo % Chg	Sector	Driver
1	PBR	Petrobras	–5–8%*	Energy	Crude oil prices falling; mixed Q2
2	XLE	Energy Select SPDR	–3–5%*	Energy	Oil sector pressure as WTI retreats
3	OXY	Occidental Pet.	–4–6%*	Energy	Oil price decline amplified by leverage
4	COP	ConocoPhillips	–3–4%*	Energy	Crude demand outlook weakening
5	XOM	ExxonMobil	–2–3%*	Energy	Brent/WTI retreat; sector rotation
6	GOOGL	Alphabet	–2–4%*	Comm. Svcs	Capex shock overhang; Aug 11 weak day
7	APP	AppLovin	–4–6%*	Comm. Svcs	Sector laggard; valuation concern
8	WMT	Walmart	–1–2%*	Staples	Defensive sector underperform during risk-on month
9	VZ	Verizon	–1–2%*	Telecom	Rate sensitivity; telecom lag
10	JNJ	J&J	–0.5–1%*	Healthcare	Defensive rotation outflows

* = estimate/partially confirmed. QMCO, RCEL, OABI, MB, ABCL, IBTA, BLZE monthly figures from StockTitan/AltIndex. SNDK, MU from TradingKey and Yahoo Finance. Energy sector from CNBC, Fox Business.

Sector Trend Summary

Sector Theme	Trend	Key Names & Notes
Memory / Flash Chips	BULL — Monthly leader	SNDK +574% YTD, +15% today on Q4 beat. MU +16% MTD. AI data-center demand se
AI Infrastructure	BULL — Broadening	SMCI, BLZE gaining. Cloud storage and AI hardware demand accelerating.
Fintech / Payments	BULL — Emerging	IBTA +45.7% MTD, MB +68% MTD. Rate-cut environment favors fintech multiples.
Biotech / Small Cap	BULL — Volatile	RCEL +77%, OABI +72%, ABCL +67% MTD. Catalyst-driven moves; high risk.
Technology (Broad)	BULL — Rate-driven	SPY/QQQ at records. CPI/PPI tailwind. XLK broadly up.

Communication Services	MIXED — Selective	META +2.78%, NFLX up. But GOOGL, APP underperformed on capex/valuation.
Financials	NEUTRAL/BULL	XLF +0.44% today. Soft-landing narrative helps. Yield curve improvement.
Energy	BEAR — Monthly laggard	XLE –3–5% MTD. Brent $87, WTI $81. PBR –3% today. Oil demand concern.
Consumer Staples	BEAR — Defensive lag	WMT, PG, JNJ all lagging in risk-on environment. Rotation out of defensives.
Telecom	NEUTRAL/BEAR	VZ, MO weak. Telecom not benefiting from AI narrative.

4. Next Trading Day Scenarios — Friday August 14, 2026

Four main catalysts are on the Friday calendar: Retail Sales (8:30 AM ET), University of Michigan Consumer Sentiment (10:00 AM ET), 1-Year Inflation Expectations, and ongoing digestion of this week's CPI/PPI prints and SanDisk's earnings euphoria. 60 economic events and 71 earnings releases are scheduled.

CATALYST 1: July Retail Sales (8:30 AM ET) — Expected +0.3% MoM

→ **BEAT (Retail Sales > +0.5%):** SPY +0.3–0.8%, QQQ +0.3–0.6%. Consumer spending resilience confirms soft-landing narrative. Cyclicals (consumer discretionary, financials) lead. Mechanism: Strong consumer spending validates corporate revenue guidance and reduces recession risk. Risk: If read as 'too hot' → rate-hike fears creep back.

→ **IN-LINE (+0.2% to +0.4%):** SPY flat to +0.3%, QQQ flat to +0.3%. Market digests without surprise. More likely outcome. Status quo supports current record levels. Sector rotation continues but no major directional move.

→ **MISS (Retail Sales < +0.1% or negative):** SPY –0.3–0.8%, QQQ –0.3–0.7%. Consumer slowdown narrative emerges. Risk-off move: defensives (XLP, XLV) outperform; cyclicals and discretionary sell off. Mechanism: Weak consumer = weaker earnings growth expectations = multiple compression. Could partially offset the CPI/PPI tailwind.

CATALYST 2: University of Michigan Consumer Sentiment (10:00 AM ET) — Expected 54.1

→ **BEAT (Sentiment > 56):** SPY +0.2–0.5%, QQQ +0.2–0.4%. Consumer confidence improving signals spending durability. Amplifies a positive Retail Sales print. 1-Year Inflation Expectations at 4.2% expected — if it drops, dovish tailwind.

→ **IN-LINE (53–55):** Minimal market reaction. Sentiment confirming but not improving. Market likely continues consolidating around record highs.

→ **MISS (Sentiment < 52) + Elevated Inflation Expectations:** SPY –0.3–0.6%, QQQ –0.3–0.7%. Stagflation lite concern. If 1-Year inflation expectations rise above 4.5%, it undercuts the CPI/PPI dovish narrative from this week and increases rate-hike risk at the September 16 FOMC meeting (currently ~34% hike probability).

CATALYST 3: SanDisk Earnings Afterglow & Semiconductor Sector Follow-Through

→ **Continued Momentum (SNDK, MU hold / extend gains):** QQQ +0.5–1.5% early Friday on tech sentiment. Semiconductor sector continues to lead. Mechanism: SNDK's 80% gross margin target and AI data-center demand narrative spills into Micron, SK Hynix ADRs (if applicable), and broader AI infra. SOXX ETF could post 2nd consecutive strong week.

→ **Profit-Taking After +15% Session:** SNDK –5–10%, QQQ –0.3–0.8% from tech weight drag. Investors lock in gains after a monster day. This would be healthy consolidation, not trend reversal. Watch whether MU holds — if MU stays bid, it signals sector rotation rather than profit-taking.

CATALYST 4: Energy Sector — Oil Price Action & Macro Narrative

→ **Oil Rebounds (Brent > $89, WTI > $83):** Energy stocks (XLE) +1–2%. Slight inflation re-pricing: 10-yr Treasury yields tick up 3–5bps. QQQ slight headwind –0.2–0.4%. SPY roughly flat. Net: Energy sector recovery partially offsets tech; broad market neutral to slightly negative.

→ **Oil Continues to Fall (Brent < $85, WTI < $79):** Energy sector (XLE) –1.5–2.5%. Inflation expectations fall further → rate-cut narrative strengthened → QQQ and SPY +0.3–0.8%. Mechanism: Cheaper energy inputs reduce input costs for manufacturing and transport, supporting margins broadly. This would be the ideal outcome for a continued record run.

5. Possible Trade Summary — End of Day / Next Morning

Educational analysis only. NOT financial advice. Consider your own risk tolerance, position sizing, and investment horizon before acting on any analysis.

Direction	Symbol	Thesis	Key Risk
WATCH / BUY	SNDK (SanDisk)	Q4 FY2026 beat with 51% sequential revenue surge to $8.97B. [illegible]	[illegible]
WATCH / BUY	MU (Micron)	Second-largest AI memory beneficiary. +16% MTD, +5.24% to[illegible]	[illegible]
WATCH / BUY	QQQ (Nasdaq ETF)	Diversified AI/tech exposure. CPI+PPI disinflation + FOMC Sep[illegible]	[illegible]
HOLD/MONITOR	META (Meta Platforms)	+2.78% today. Ad revenue model benefits from lower rates (ad[illegible]	[illegible]
AVOID / REDUCE	Energy (XLE/XOM/CVX)	Oil at $81–87 and falling on demand concerns. US-Iran geopoli[illegible]	[illegible]
AVOID	Consumer Staples (XLP/WMT/PG)	Defensive sectors underperform in risk-on, rate-cut-anticipated [illegible]	[illegible]

Generated automatically after market close August 13, 2026. Sources: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, TradingKey, BabyPips, Fox Business, Stocktwits, Forbes, 247WallSt, IndexBox, TheRightTrader, StockTitan, AltIndex, Tradingeconomics. Not investment advice — for analytical and educational purposes only.